Egypt University of Informatics
Computer and Information Systems
Data Analysis Course

# The Analysis of Students' Balance Between Studying and Leisure Time

Submitted by:

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|---|---|
| Mohamed Elkersh | 24-101277 |
| Moataz Wael | 24-101094 |
| Eyad Mohamed | 24-101210 |
| Abdelrahman Walid | 24-101045 |


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## Introduction

Balancing study time and leisure time is one of the main daily challenges students deal with. If a student spends too much time on leisure activities, their academic work can be affected. On the other hand, if a student focuses too much on studying without enough rest or free time, this can lead to stress, frustration, and lower satisfaction. This topic is important because time management does not only affect academic performance, but also affects well-being, motivation, and overall student life. This report analyzes survey data collected from students to understand whether leisure takes more space in their daily routine and how this balance is related to stress, satisfaction, and students' own view of their time management.

## Research Question

How do students balance studying and leisure time, and does weaker time balance appear to be associated with higher stress and lower satisfaction?

## Hypothesis

The hypothesis of this study is that many students spend more time daily on leisure activities than on studying, and that a weaker balance between the two is connected to higher stress levels and lower satisfaction.

## Population of Interest:

The population of interest in this study is students, mainly university students. Since the survey was shared online through student groups and networks, the sample mostly represents undergraduate students and other respondents who are in the student age group.

## Sampling Method:

The sampling method used in this project is convenience sampling. This was the most suitable choice for this study because the survey was distributed through online student groups and social media, which made it easier to collect responses within the required time. Even though convenience sampling does not give perfect representation, the survey was shared with students from different majors and academic years, instead of only one class or one friend group, which helped make the sample more varied.

## Bias Identification:

Several possible sources of bias were considered while designing the survey. First, selection bias may be present because students who decided to answer the survey may be different from those who did not respond. Second, self-report bias may also exist because respondents may not describe their habits fully accurately, or they may answer in a way they think looks better. To reduce these risks, the questions were written in a neutral and non-judgmental way, the form was anonymous, and the survey was shared across different student groups to reduce overrepresentation from one specific subgroup.

## Survey Questions:

1. On average, how many hours per day do you spend on leisure activities?

2. Which area takes more of your daily time?

3. How often do leisure activities interfere with your study time?

4. Do you think you manage your time effectively between studying and leisure?

5. How satisfied are you with your current balance between studying and leisure?

Online survey link: [Click Here]

Number of samples collected: 60

## Analysis:

To analyze the data collected from the survey, descriptive statistics such as the mean, median, and mode were calculated for the main variables. For leisure hours, category midpoints were used to estimate a numeric average, while ordinal coding was used for variables such as stress, interference, and satisfaction.

Visual representations were also created to show the main patterns in the data more clearly. The charts below focus on leisure time, which side takes more time in students' daily lives, whether leisure activities interfere with studying, students' satisfaction with their current balance, and the relationship between interference and stress.

Each visualization is followed by a short explanation of what it shows and what conclusions can reasonably be taken from it.

The dataset contains 60 valid responses. Most respondents were male (70.0%), most were second-year students (56.7%), and 91.7% identified as full-time students. These characteristics help explain the context of the findings, but they also show that the sample is not equally balanced across all student groups.

### Summary of descriptive statistics

| Variable | Mean | Median | Mode |
|---|---|---|---|
| Daily leisure hours | 3.67 | 3.5 | 3–4 hours |
| Academic stress level | 2.97 | 3 | Often |
| Leisure interference | 2.8 | 3 | Often |
| Balance satisfaction | 2.68 | 3 | Neutral |

*Leisure-hour mean uses category midpoints. Stress and interference were coded on a 1–4 ordinal scale. Satisfaction was coded on a 1–5 ordinal scale.*

## Figure 1. Daily Hours Spent on Leisure Activities

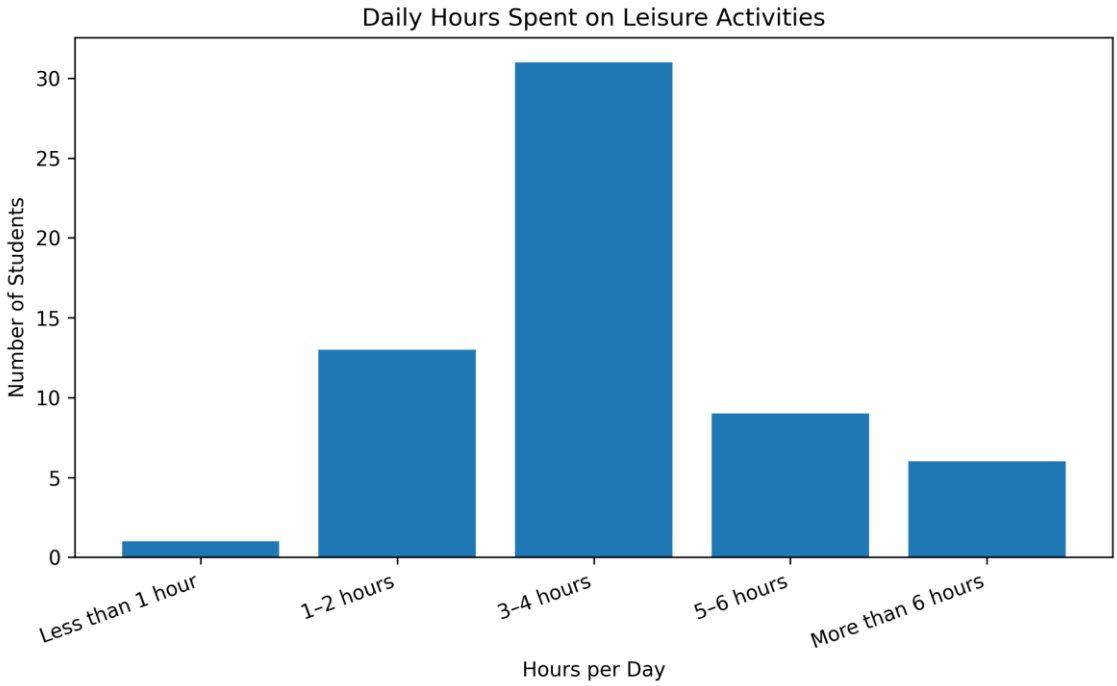


Figure 1 shows that the biggest group of students, 31 out of 60 respondents (51.7%), spend around 3–4 hours per day on leisure activities. Another 15 students (25.0%) spend 5 hours or more, while only one student reported spending less than 1 hour. This shows that leisure takes up a noticeable part of many students' daily routine.

## Figure 2. Which Area Takes More of Students' Daily Time?

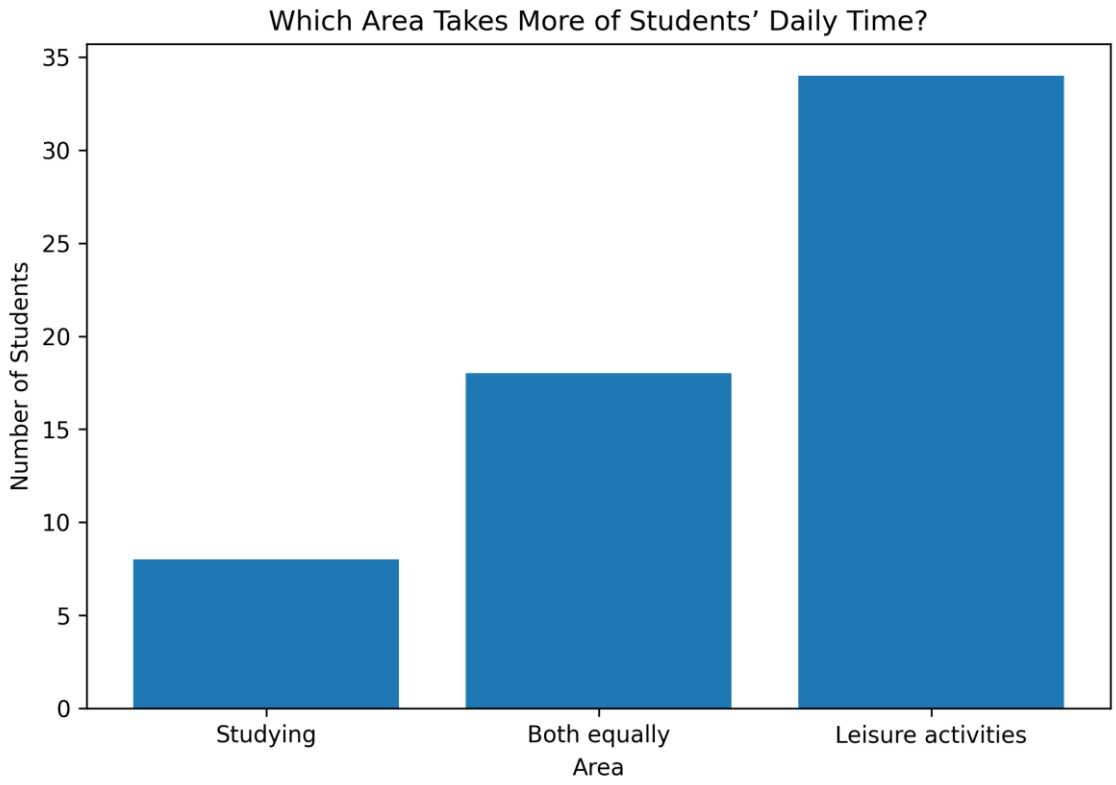


Figure 2 compares whether studying, leisure, or both equally take more of students' time each day. Most respondents, 34 students (56.7%), said that leisure activities take more of their time, while 18 students (30.0%) chose both equally and only 8 students (13.3%) chose studying. This supports the idea that leisure tends to take a larger share of daily time than studying for many students.

## Figure 3. How Often Leisure Activities Interfere with Studying

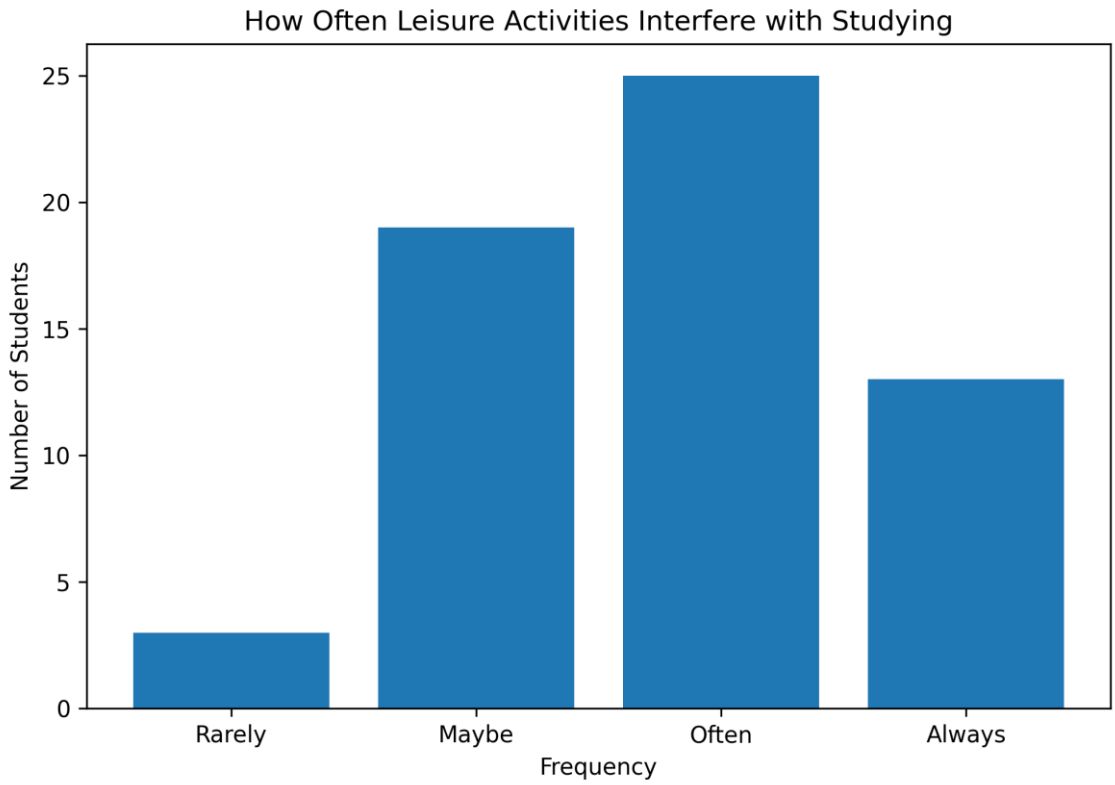


Figure 3 shows how often leisure activities interfere with study time. A large part of the respondents reported clear interference, with 25 students (41.7%) choosing “Often” and 13 students (21.7%) choosing “Always.” This means that 63.3% of the sample face regular interference, which suggests that the problem is not just the amount of leisure time itself, but the way it can affect academic responsibilities.

**Figure 4. Satisfaction with the Study–Leisure Balance**

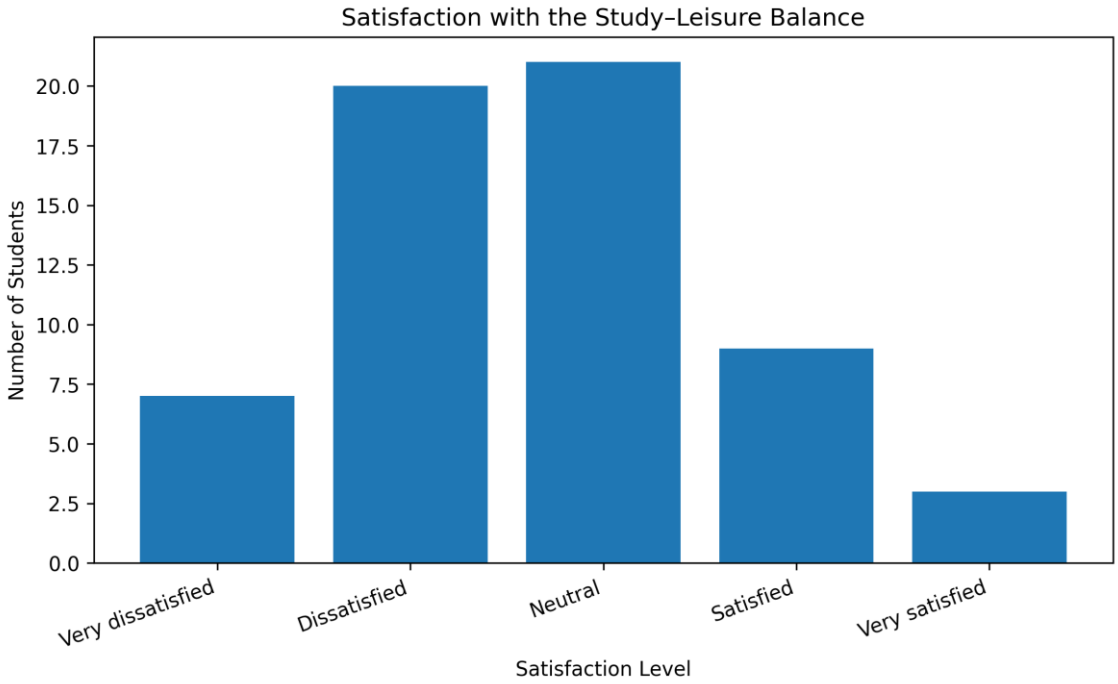


Figure 4 shows students' satisfaction with their current balance between studying and leisure. The most common response was Neutral, selected by 21 students, but dissatisfaction was also high, with 20 students saying they were dissatisfied and 7 saying they were very dissatisfied. Only 12 students in total said they were satisfied or very satisfied, which suggests that many students are not fully happy with the balance they currently have.

## Figure 5. Stress Level vs. Leisure Interference

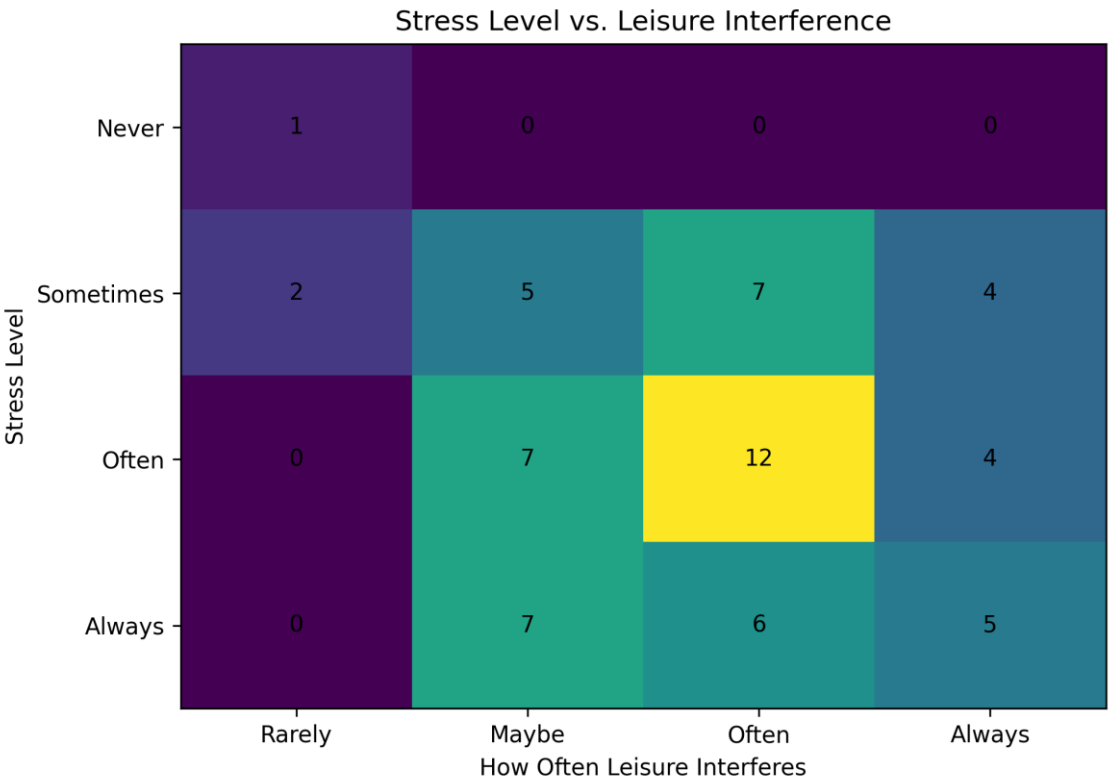


Figure 5 compares academic stress with how often leisure activities interfere with studying. The strongest pattern appears in the categories where students reported that leisure interferes often or always, and where stress is also reported often or always. Even though this does not prove a direct cause-and-effect relationship, it still suggests that weaker balance between studying and leisure may be connected to higher academic stress.

The additional findings from the survey also support the main results. A total of 38 students (63.3%) said that they do not manage their time effectively between studying and leisure, and 58 students (96.7%) believed that better time management would improve their academic performance. The same number also said that they would like to improve their current balance, which shows that most respondents are aware of the problem and believe that improving it would be helpful.

## Conclusion

The survey results suggest that leisure time has a major role in students' daily lives and often competes with studying. More than half of the respondents said that leisure activities take more of their daily time than studying, and many students also reported that leisure often or always interferes with their study time. At the same time, satisfaction with the current balance was mostly low to moderate, and most respondents believed that better time management could improve their academic performance. In general, the findings support the hypothesis that weaker balance between studying and leisure is linked to higher stress and lower satisfaction. However, it is still important to note that the results are based on students' self-reported opinions and perceptions, not on direct measurement of study hours.

## Issues faced

One limitation of this study is that convenience sampling was used, so the sample may not fully represent all students. Another issue is that the survey measured leisure hours directly, but it did not collect exact numeric study hours, which means the comparison between studying and leisure depends partly on perception-based questions, such as which area takes more time and whether leisure interferes with studying. Also, a large portion of the sample consisted of second-year students, which may have influenced the overall pattern of the results. In future research, the data collection could be improved by using a more balanced sample and by including exact daily study hours as well as leisure hours.